5 Securing your system: IAM, security groups, and VPC

This chapter covers

- Who is responsible for security?
- Keeping your software up-to-date
- Controlling access to your AWS account with users and roles
- Keeping your traffic under control with security groups
- Using CloudFormation to create a private network

If security is a wall, you'll need a lot of bricks to build that wall, as shown in figure 5.1. This chapter focuses on the following four most important bricks to secure your systems on AWS:

1. *Installing software updates*—New security vulnerabilities are found in software every day. Software vendors release updates to fix those vulnerabilities, and it's your job to install those updates as quickly as possible after they're released on your systems. Otherwise, your systems will be an easy victim for hackers.